ment is setting up an investor facilitation cell within the Directorate of Tourism. This cell, integrated with the Maharashtra Industry, Trade, and Investment Facilitation Cell (MAITRI), will serve as a one-stop solution for investors, providing essential information on business approvals and helping with the promotion of tourism investments.

A single-window clearance mechanism will also be introduced, aimed at simplifying and expediting the process of obtaining necessary approvals for tourism units. This online system will reduce delays, eliminate redundant processes, and offer automated workflows in line with the citizen charter, significantly easing the investment and operational processes for stakeholders in the tourism industry.

**Fiscal & Non-Fiscal Incentives**

In addition to fiscal benefits, the policy offers a range of non-fiscal incentives aimed at supporting specific tourism sectors. Agritourism, for instance, will be bolstered by recognizing businesses such as goat rearing, dairying, and bee-keeping as agribusinesses. Farmers involved in agritourism will also receive licenses for up to 10 years, allowing them to sell their produce and local handicrafts to visiting tourists.

Caravan tourism operators will benefit from favorable status for their vehicles, including registration as tourist vehicles. Moreover, several tourism projects, including caravan parks and adventure sports, will be exempt from non-agricultural taxes, providing further impetus to innovative tourism ventures.

**Additional Incentives and Opportunities**

The policy extends support to initiatives that promote Maharashtra's rich cultural heritage. Individuals or groups involved in preserving traditional arts, music, and cuisine will be eligible for a one-time incentive of INR 5 lakh, encouraging the conservation of indigenous practices within a 50-kilometer radius of major tourist attractions.

Further, innovative tourism projects will be recognized, with INR 50,000 awarded to the top 10 initiatives. Projects meeting sustainable tourism criteria as outlined by the Union Ministry of Tourism will also be eligible for substantial reimbursements, promoting innovation and sustainability within the sector.

**Conclusion**

Maharashtra's new tourism policy is a forward-thinking and comprehensive blueprint designed to drive growth, attract investment, and create job opportunities across the state. By focusing on sustainable practices, infrastructure development, and inclusivity, the government is positioning Maharashtra as a global destination for travelers, investors, and stakeholders alike. With its ambitious goals, this policy promises to be a game-changer, propelling the state toward a prosperous future.

## Monetary Incentives

The state will be introducing a bevy of financial incentives that can be availed by eligible tourism units. Here's a look at some of them

**All eligible tourism units as defined in this policy will be eligible for capital investment incentives as per the table below:**

| CATEGORY | TYPE OF UNIT | INCENTIVES |
|---|---|---|
| **Accommodations (A)** | Hotels/motels/youth hostels/youth clubs/ resorts/log huts/cottages | 20 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 20 crore, whichever is less |
| **Accommodations (B)** | Serviced apartments/tourist villas/time -sharing resorts/Agro, rural or eco-tourism units/ homestays/bed and breakfast/vacation rental homes/ tented accommodations/tourist apartments/bamboo huts/tree houses/ mud cottages/cruise boats/yachts/ houseboats | 15 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 15 crore, whichever is less |
| **Food and beverages** | Wayside amenities/restaurants,food kiosks or food courts at tourist destinations /beach shacks/tents/glass pods, etc. with scientific waste management facilities | 15 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 15 crore, whichever whichever is less |
| **Travel and tourism** | MICE or convention centres/exhibition spaces/ wellness centres or hospitality training centres/hotel management institutes/tourist facilitation centres, etc. | 15 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 15 crore, whichever is less |
| **Entertainment and recreation** | Ropeways cable cars/amusement parks / theme parks/adventure tourism units or parks/ golf course/caravan and caravan park/heli tourism projects/ unity malls/AR-VR zones/7D and above experiences/global tourism village/ art and cultural centres, etc./amphitheatres/ theatres/art galleries/viewing gallerles/ retall zones such as shopping malls/ multiplexes/ video game zones (only if it's part of any other eligible tourism unit) | 15 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 15 crore, whichever is less |
| **Other tourism units** | Handloom/handicraft shops<br>Development of adventure tourism landing sites<br>E-vehicles for tourists<br>Restoration/conservation of historical/ heritage structures/accommodations/ buildings used as tourist attractions | 15 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 10 lakh, whichever is less |
| | **Ultra mega project unit** | 10 per cent of the eligible capital investment or Rs 25 crore, whichever is less |

## Incentives for Tourism Units

| | A | B | C | STZ/ STD |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **ELIGIBILITY PERIOD (IN YEARS)** | **3** | **3** | **5** | **5** |
| SGST reimbursement | 50 per cent of SGST off on net paid | 75 per cent of SGST off on net paid | 100 per cent of SGST off on net paid | 100 per cent of SGST off on net paid |
| Electricity duty exemption | 50 per cent | 75 per cent | 100 per cent | 100 per cent |
| Electricity tariff refund (difference between commercial tariff and industrial tariff) | 50 per cent | 75 per cent | 100 per cent | 100 per cent |
| Interest subventions | Up to 5 per cent interest subventions on loans of up to Rs 2 crore. Ceiling on total interest subventions shall be Rs 5 lakh. | Up to 5 per cent interest subventions on loans of up to Rs 2 crore. Ceiling on total interest subventions shall be Rs 5 lakh. | Up to 5 per cent interest subventions on loans of up to Rs 2 crore. Ceiling on total interest subventions shall be Rs 10 lakh. | Up to 5 per cent interest subventions on loans of up to Rs 2 crore. Ceiling on total interest subventions shall be Rs 10 lakh. |
| Stamp duty and registration charges exemption | **50 per cent** | **75 percent** | **100 per cent** | **100 per cent** |
| | Sale/lease deeds executed in respect of purchase/lease of land/built-up area for a tourism project, provided that the sale or lease deed is entered into during the period of the policy. Mortgage and hypothecation for undertaking a tourism project during the period of the policy | | | |

- The above incentives shall not exceed the eligible fixed capital investment of the project, with ih the given eligible period, whichever is earlier.
- Eligible units should register with the Directorate of Tourism and Ministry of Tourism. Also, use of the booking platform of DoT is mandatory if available.
- To avail of incentives, registered units must apply to the Directorate of Tourism for an eligibility certificate.